

11 Common issues

Your phone is a complicated piece of equipment. Sure, it's small, and it appears relatively simple on the outside, but a lot of little things can go wrong. We don't want to scare you, though. Most of the problems you will encounter are pretty simple to resolve. This chapter covers a few of the basic problems you might encounter and helps you take some steps to fix them.

Anything can break. Even going back to the tin cans connected with string that you might have used as a child, problems happen. If the string broke, you couldn't hear the other person. Technology is no different. As technology gets more advanced, often more individual components can have problems. Hardware issues can take several different forms.

11.1 My Phone Is Damn Slow

If you've been using your phone for a while, you might notice that tapping an icon or pressing a button doesn't work as well as it used to. You might tap the Browser picture and have to wait a full minute for the browser to open. Or you might press the Home button while browsing the Internet and have to wait for what seems like forever to return to the home screen.

The most common reason for this is that a program on your phone isn't releasing resources properly. That sounds kind of complicated, so let's explore it a little bit. Your phone has a limited amount of memory. Think of memory as a bowl of pebbles. Every time you use a program (such as Gmail or the browser), that program takes a handful of pebbles from the bowl and uses them to do things such as display text on the screen. Usually, when you close a program, it puts all those pebbles back in the bowl. However, sometimes the program holds onto those pebbles. If you have too many programs holding onto their pebbles, the bowl eventually will be nearly empty. If the bowl is nearly empty, any new program won't be able to grab enough pebbles to run well.

This problem has a couple of resolutions. The easiest solution is to simply reboot your phone. Rebooting is the technical term for turning the power off.

If this does not resolve the slow response time, a recently installed program probably is causing your phone to run slowly. Start with the last application you installed, and uninstall it. To uninstall an application, follow these steps:

- Tap the Application tab, and then tap Settings.
- Tap Applications.